number of gallantry awards for this action and most importantly, the ‘battle honour’ of Jamalpur. I gave a brief of this historical account to Lieutenant Colonel K.S. Brar, VrC, while doing the staff college course in 1976, as he was my instructor at Wellington.

After two months or so at Dhana, I returned to Poona and it was once again back to the normal grind. Like me, most of my colleagues had served for eight to ten years, and we all aspired to do the Staff College Course. The entrance examination was in February 1973, and as is the norm, all of us were hopeful of doing the pre-staff course and taking leave to study for the exam. However, the commandant of the Intelligence School, Colonel Balakrishnan, was faced with a dilemma. How could he run the institution with five of his instructors being away? Therefore, he gave a ruling that none of us would be given leave or a chance to do the pre-staff course. Now it was up to us to decide whether to sit for the exam or not. Practically all of us accepted the terms of reference and took the exam from the ‘line of march’, so to say. I appeared for the Part ‘D’ promotion exam in November 1972, and two months later sat for the Staff College entrance exam along with the others. In between both these exams, our son, Vivek, was born on Christmas day, a little after midnight. When the results came out in May or June 1973, out of five of us, three had qualified in the examination, including me (the other two were Captains S.S. Mehta and Satpal Sandhu). I proved to be the dark horse, the only one to get a competitive vacancy (amongst the top twenty in the order of merit). This tenure was professionally and socially very stimulating and active. We were a young and energetic team of instructors in the process of enhancing our professional knowledge, and had a good circle of friends.

On completion of my tenure, I was posted back to 9 Maratha LI. The battalion was stationed in Malari, a high-altitude area on the Indo-Tibet border, beyond Joshimath. My stay in the ‘paltan’ was shortlived as I was required to join the Staff College at Wellington in